

STARTER

Field-by-Field Online Application Walkthrough

United Kingdom - Student Visa

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

The Student visa application is completed online at gov.uk (search “Student visa”). It's decided under Appendix Student of the Immigration Rules, on a points-based system - you need 70 points in total: 50 for a valid Confirmation of Acceptance for Studies (CAS) and course, 10 for meeting the English language requirement, and 10 for meeting the financial (maintenance) requirement. Gather the following before you begin:

- Your CAS reference number, issued by your Student sponsor (your university or college) - you can't start the application without one
- Valid passport or other travel document
- Evidence of your English language ability (usually met through your course itself, an approved test, or your nationality/prior education, depending on your circumstances)
- Financial evidence covering course fees and living costs - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier)
- ATAS certificate, if your course and nationality require one (certain postgraduate research courses, mainly in STEM and security-relevant fields)
- Tuberculosis (TB) test certificate, if you're resident in a country where this is required for UK visa applications - check the current list on gov.uk

YOUR CAS COMES FIRST

Your sponsor issues the CAS only once you've accepted an unconditional offer and (usually) paid any required deposit. Everything on the application must match the CAS exactly - course title, dates, sponsor details, and your own passport and personal details. Mismatches are one of the most common refusal causes; see the Refusal Reasons guide.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport - and exactly as they were given to your sponsor when your CAS was issued.

2. Your CAS and course details

Enter your CAS reference number; the system pulls through details your sponsor submitted (course title, level, start and end dates, tuition fees, and whether any deposit has already been paid). Check every field against your own offer letter and CAS statement.

- If you're switching from another UK immigration route (e.g. completing one course and progressing to another), you'll be asked about your current visa - your new course must generally represent academic progression from your previous one
- If you're under 18 at the time of application, you'll be routed to Child Student requirements, which differ in some respects from the standard Student route

3. English language

You'll confirm how you meet the requirement - most commonly because your course itself is taught in English at degree level or above and your sponsor has confirmed this, or through an approved Secure English Language Test (SELT), or because of your nationality or prior qualifications. Your sponsor's CAS usually already confirms which basis applies.

4. Financial requirement

You'll declare how you're funding your course fees and living costs, and provide supporting evidence. The system calculates a suggested amount based on your course length and location (London or elsewhere) - see the Financial Requirements Overview for exactly how this is worked out, and the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier) to model your own figures.

5. Immigration history

Any previous UK visas, visits, extensions, refusals, or breaches - answer completely. If you're already in the UK on a Student visa and switching or extending, this section is checked closely against your Home Office record.

6. Criminal and security declarations

Standard declarations covering criminal convictions, security concerns, and previous immigration breaches. Answer honestly - these are checked against records.

7. Pay the fee and the Immigration Health Surcharge (IHS)

You'll pay the visa application fee and the Immigration Health Surcharge, which covers your access to the NHS for the length of your stay and is charged upfront for the full course duration. You'll then book a biometric appointment, unless you're eligible to use the UK immigration "ID Check" app instead.

8. Upload supporting documents

Upload your CAS statement, financial evidence, ATAS certificate (if required), TB test certificate (if required), and any academic documents requested. Follow the specific instructions given after you book your appointment - they vary by location.